Returns and Escalation Policy

When a prepared reply to a customer must be read by a person before it is sent.

Version 2.0 · Customer Operations

Each clause below states a condition under which a reply must be routed to human review before release. A clause carries the legal basis it derives from, or is marked as company policy where none applies.

1. Personal and payment data

Applies to any personal identifier appearing in an inbound message or an outbound reply. Values already reduced by the masking layer are out of scope.

1.1 G-PII-001 · PII

If the reply repeats personal identifiers that are not needed to answer the request like a date of birth, a home address, a national identification number, then route the case to human review. Values that appear partly hidden, like DE89****00 or ****1111, have already been masked by the system and are safe to send. A customer's own name in a reply addressed to that customer is not a reason for review.

Basis: GDPR Art. 5(1)(c) - data minimisation

1.2 G-PII-002 · PII

If the customer has disclosed account credentials or a password, route the case to human review. The reply must never repeat or acknowledge the credential.

Basis: GDPR Art. 32 - security of processing

2. Legal escalation and payment disputes

Applies where a customer invokes an external authority, whether a court, a lawyer, or their payment provider.

2.1 G-LEG-001 · LEGAL_THREAT

If the customer refers to a lawyer, legal action, court proceedings, or a small-claims filing, route the case to human review regardless of the refund decision.

Basis: ADR Directive 2013/11/EU; German VSBG

2.2 G-LEG-003 · LEGAL_THREAT

If the customer threatens a chargeback or a payment dispute through their bank or card issuer, route the case to human review.

Basis: PSD2 (Directive 2015/2366); card scheme chargeback rules

3. Replies that do not match the decision

Applies where the reply and the recorded decision are inconsistent with one another, or where the reply

answers a question that was not asked.

3.1 G-MIS-001 · POLICY_MISMATCH_RISK

If the reply communicates an outcome that contradicts the recorded business decision - for example the decision denies the refund but the reply says it was approved - route the case to human review.

Basis: UCPD 2005/29/EC - misleading information to consumers

3.2 G-MIS-002 · POLICY_MISMATCH_RISK

If the business decision is to request more information but the reply grants or refuses the refund outright, route the case to human review.

Basis: UCPD 2005/29/EC - misleading information to consumers

3.3 G-MIS-003 · POLICY_MISMATCH_RISK

If the reply states a refund amount, method, or timeline that the recorded facts do not support, route the case to human review rather than committing to it. Promising a refund once the returned item has been received and checked is correct and is not a mismatch, saying a refund has already been issued for an item still with the customer is.

Basis: UCPD 2005/29/EC - misleading information to consumers

3.4 G-MIS-004 · POLICY_MISMATCH_RISK

If the reply describes the state of the return in a way the recorded facts do not support - telling a customer whose item has been received that it has not arrived, or treating an item still with the customer as already back - route the case to human review. The same applies if the reply contradicts itself about whether the item has been received.

Basis: UCPD 2005/29/EC - misleading information to consumers

3.5 G-MIS-005 · POLICY_MISMATCH_RISK

If the customer asks to swap or exchange the item for a different one, route the case to human review.

Basis: Company policy

4. Fraud and account abuse

Applies to signals originating in the account record rather than in the message.

4.1 G-FRD-001 · FRAUD_RISK

If the account carries a fraud, abuse, or chargeback-history flag, route the case to human review regardless of the refund decision.

Basis: Company policy

4.2 G-FRD-002 · FRAUD_RISK

If the customer's refunds in the last twelve months exceed 40% of the orders they have placed, and they have placed at least three orders, route the case to human review.

Basis: Company policy

4.3 G-FRD-003 · FRAUD_RISK

If the customer's account of events conflicts with the recorded facts - for example claiming non-delivery for an order recorded as delivered - route the case to human review.

Basis: Company policy

5. Incomplete or conflicting information

Applies where the case cannot be decided on the facts available.

5.1 G-INF-001 · MISSING_INFO

Missing facts are not by themselves a reason for review; asking the customer for what is missing may be sent automatically. Route to review only if the recorded facts contradict each other, or the customer is asking for something the system has no way to handle.

Basis: Company policy

6. Customer relationship

Applies where the decision is correct but releasing it unsupervised would damage the relationship.

6.1 G-BUS-001 · BUSINESS_RISK

If the reply communicates a partial refund and the customer has already disputed the condition of the item - saying it arrived that way, or that they barely used it - route the case to human review. A partial refund the customer has not challenged may be sent automatically.

Basis: Company policy

6.2 G-BUS-002 · BUSINESS_RISK

If a refusal is going to someone plainly upset - voicing disappointment, or asking for an exception - and their account shows many orders with few refunds, route it to human review as a goodwill decision.

Basis: Company policy

6.3 G-BUS-003 · BUSINESS_RISK

If someone has died, or the customer is grieving or seriously ill, route the case to human review whatever the refund decision is.

Basis: FCA FG21/1 - fair treatment of vulnerable customers

7. Replies that may be released without review

The clauses in this section permit release. They exist so that the absence of an escalation trigger is stated positively rather than inferred.

7.1 G-AUTO-001 · NONE

A refund approval that matches the business decision, is supported by complete facts, and contains no personal identifiers, legal escalation, or fraud indicators may be sent automatically.

Basis: Company policy

7.2 G-AUTO-002 · NONE

A refund denial may be sent automatically when the reason is verifiable from the recorded facts - such as a clearly expired return window - and the message contains no legal, fraud, or personal-data indicators.

Basis: Company policy

Version 2.0 · 18 clauses